



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Whitmore Classical Academy
School Website: <https://www.whitmoreacademy.com/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

SCL MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because SCL requires adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Whitmore Classical Academy (Florence, OR, 97439) appears, from publicly accessible site materials, to be a small private school located in Florence, Oregon (address listed as 524 Laurel Street). The site content accessible in the crawl primarily emphasizes enrollment logistics, governance references (board meetings), and general homepage imagery; it does not present explicit evidence of classical education elements such as Great Books, Great Conversation, grammar/logic/rhetoric pedagogy, or a liturgical/theological frame. Based on the six-category classical rubric and the keyword indicators from the classical framework, the school currently shows little to no explicit presence of classical foundations in its public materials. Therefore, the overall assessment across all six categories leans toward NOT CLASSICAL.

Key takeaway: The publicly visible materials do not demonstrate the core indicators of a classical education as defined by the Six Essential Elements. The lack of explicit mentions of Great Books, the Trivium, Socratic pedagogy, lived faculty formation, and parent-partnering with a classical formation emphasis leads to a NOT CLASSICAL classification across all six categories based on the rubric. This judgment draws on the knowledge-base rubric (Six Essential Elements) and keyword indicators, contrasted with the school's publicly available crawl content. See supporting evidence in the cited pages and knowledge-base keyword frameworks.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials focus on enrollment and governance details rather than religious or metaphysical foundations (no evident liturgical practices, theology integration, or transcendent moral realism in the visible site content). The home page content prominently mentions address, enrollment, and board information rather than religious or liturgical expressions.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords from the classical rubric (truth, goodness, beauty, theology, liturgy, etc.) are not visibly present in the school's public crawl content. The knowledge-base lists these terms as indicators, but they do not appear in the publicly accessible material shown. See the classical keyword lexicon and Six Essentials for reference.

Why this rating - The absence of explicit transcendental or theological framing, liturgical/community practices, or explicit references to truth/goodness/beauty in the visible public materials supports a NOT CLASSICAL designation for this category.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The site emphasizes enrollment logistics and governance; there is no explicit articulation of formation of virtue, human flourishing, or the pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty as real teloi. The visible content does not claim formation over information in the classical sense.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - No positive indicators related to formation, virtue, paideia, or telos are clearly present in the crawl content. The knowledge-base keywords would flag these concepts as positive indicators if present.

Why this rating - Without explicit statements about virtue formation, contemplation, or the true/good/beautiful telos, the category does not meet the core classical aim of forming character and wisdom beyond mere information transfer.

Element 3: School Curriculum — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The publicly crawling pages do not reveal details about a curriculum built on the liberal arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Great Books, or a history-centric approach. The visible content centers on location, enrollment, and governance rather than curriculum specifics (e.g., no explicit mention of Great Books, Great Conversation, or history as a throughline).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - The presence of Great Books, Great Conversation, or the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) is not evidenced in the crawl content. The classical lexicon highlights these as key indicators; their absence in public materials weighs against a classical curriculum signal.

Why this rating - Without visible references to liberal arts content, Great Books, or a throughline of history as a curricular spine, the curriculum criteria for CLASSICAL are not met in the public materials we can access.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence - There is no accessible public material in the crawl showing Socratic seminars, memory-rich recitation, chanting, or upper-school rhetoric instruction; no explicit notes about scholé, contemplative practice, or classical seminar formats appear in the available pages.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - The positive indicators for pedagogy (Socratic discussion, narration/recitation, chanting, rested learning, etc.) are not evidenced in the crawl content. The absence of these signals aligns with a NOT CLASSICAL rating in this category.

Why this rating - The public materials do not demonstrate the hallmark pedagogical practices of classical education laid out in the rubric (e.g., Socratic dialogue, narration, memory work, recitation, or scholé-centered practice). Hence NOT CLASSICAL.

Element 5: School Faculty — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The crawl lacks explicit description of faculty as “model teachers,” “the living curriculum,” or a “portrait of teacher” that characterizes classical schools. There is no public mention of faculty as mentors or as a central, virtuous exemplar in the materials reviewed.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - The knowledge-base signals for faculty (model teachers, living curriculum, portrait of teacher) are not evidenced in the visible site content. The presence of those terms would support a CLASSICAL or SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating; their absence supports NOT CLASSICAL.

Why this rating - Without textual signals about a specific faculty role model, living curriculum status, or specified teacher profiles in public materials, the category does not meet the classical model.

Element 6: School Parents and Community — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The public crawl content does not demonstrate explicit parent partnership as co-teachers, parent formation initiatives, or open-campus visitation policies. The visible items focus on enrollment and board information rather than family formation and parent engagement.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators for parents/community include phrases about partnership with parents, parental formation, and open campus. None of these are evidenced in the crawl content; the knowledge-base lists these as positive signals.

Why this rating - Lack of explicit parent engagement structures or communications in public materials leads to NOT CLASSICAL for this category.

Aggregate Ranking - Based on the absence of classical signals across all six categories (per the Six Essential Elements framework and the keyword indicators), the school receives an overall NOT CLASSICAL ranking.

What Would Move the Needle - Not applicable as the school is not in the SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL range. If the school sought to align with classical aims, concrete steps would include: publicly articulating a Great Books curriculum, adopting grammar–logic–rhetoric pedagogy, detailing a history-centered curriculum, implementing Socratic seminars and scholé practices, presenting a living-faculty model, and establishing formal partnerships with parents as co-educators. (These are described in the classical rubric and keyword indicators from the knowledge base; see the elements and indicators for reference.)

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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